of assimilation into innovation.

Despite the relative decline of the West and the apparent stagnation of the Japanese economy, they remain the most advanced centres of knowledge and innovation. India is fortunate to enjoy benign partnerships with all of them, partly motivated by a shared concern about China's expanding power. The West and Japan recognize that perhaps India is the only country which has the civilizational heft, area, population, and a significant pool of managerial, technical and entrepreneurial skills to match and even overtake China. They are, therefore, ready to invest in India's emergence as a top-ranking power.

Geopolitically, India is in a position of advantage to advance its economic prospects, and it will be the task of India's foreign policy to enable this, and of its economic policymakers to create a congenial space for a large-scale flow of capital and technology into India. It also requires India to work out a growth strategy that will be sustainable in the long term and orient its learning process towards that end. As we shall see, its goal cannot be to become another China.

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Globalization demands the ability to manage plurality as diverse societies engage with one another in a more frequent and intense manner. It is societies that are successful in managing plurality and have a cosmopolitan temperament that can stay ahead of the globalization curve. India is a true crossroads culture, having been for centuries at the centre of intersecting maritime and caravan routes. It has an extraordinarily diverse population, thanks to a long history of migration, invasion, and flourishing trade and commerce. India's successful diaspora is testimony to the adaptability of its people and their ability to function as global citizens. Though English is a language still used mainly by the educated elite, it has been an important asset in managing globalization. Compared to India, China is a more homogeneous country, and the Han majority (over 90 per cent of its total population) is still unable to manage its relations with the smaller Tibetan and Uighur populations. Their distinctive cultural and religious identities